

GWYNETH STOLO

www.linkedin.com/in/gwyneth-stolo | She/Her

EDUCATION

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona (CPP)

Master of Science in Biological Sciences

Advised by Jayson Smith, Ph.D. – Coastal Ecology Lab

Pomona, CA

August 2025 – current

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Bachelor of Science in Geology with Highest Honors | Major GPA: 3.971

Minor in Conservation Biology | Minor GPA: 4.000

Cum Laude

Los Angeles, CA

June 2023

AWARDS & HONORS

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- **Vernon Gregory Memorial Scholarship** for graduate-level research in biology (2026)
 - **Graduate Research Fund** for conducting ecology research in the field for CPP (2025)
 - **Special Thanks for Achieving Results (STAR) Award** for exceptional accomplishments during emergency assignments within the National Park Service (2025)
 - **Segal AmeriCorps Education Award** for completion of public service through Scientists-in-Parks and the Student Conservation Association (2024)
 - **Valedictorian & Eugene B. Waggoner Scholarship** for highest academic achievement of UCLA Earth, Planetary, and Space Sciences (2023)
 - **Queen's Road Foundation Undergraduate Research Fellowship** for independent research as a woman in the physical sciences (2022)
 - **Dean Oberste-Lehn Scholarship** for advanced fieldwork as a Geology major (2022)
 - **Dean's Honors List** UCLA, awarded eleven times (2020-2023)

RESEARCH & FIELD EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher

Coastal Ecology Lab, CPP, Department of Biological Sciences, Pomona, CA

Supervisor: Jayson Smith, Ph.D.

Master's thesis research focusing on rocky intertidal community analysis

August 2025 – current

- Project development
 - Reviewing relevant literature
 - Establishing a methodology for data organization and analysis
- Long-term monitoring fieldwork
 - Following Multi-Agency Rocky Intertidal Network (MARiNe) protocol to conduct long-term and biodiversity monitoring surveys
- Data analysis
 - Programming with R software

Biological Science Technician

June 2025 – August 2025

National Park Service (NPS), Oregon Caves National Monument and Preserve, Cave Junction, OR

Supervisor: Jason Walz

Natural resource management and youth corps crew leadership

- Biological monitoring
 - Conducted surveys of various wildlife populations including bat, butterfly, and cave-dwelling invertebrates
 - Assisted in the set-up and tear-down of acoustic recording devices, which included hiking with the equipment in the backcountry and driving rough terrain to remote sites
 - Identified invasive plants and facilitating their removal, using Avenza mapping software for data collection
- Physical and cave monitoring
 - Collected data for long-term hydrogeology monitoring studies
 - Collected data for long-term fire weather monitoring
 - Cleaned the cave tour path
 - Completed purchase request forms for necessary gear
- Youth Conservation Corps Crew Lead
 - Managed a team of local high school students, inspiring the next generation of conservationists
 - Led a resume-building exercise
- Communications management
 - Developed and posting social media content for official NPS accounts
 - Created a digital communications organizer and management system
 - Designed flyers for volunteer events and public events
 - Designed mock-up Dark Sky Park signage
- Event planning
 - Organized and hosting a Star Party Dark Sky event with over 50 visitors, coordinating with the local astronomy club for telescope viewing and developing an interpretive program about light pollution
 - Co-hosted the Butterfly Bioblitz and Community Non-Native Plant Removal events, interacting with over 30 volunteers
- Cave tour
 - Guided a college-level geology class on a cave tour, giving a specialized interpretive program with a geology theme

Paleontology Resource Management

June 2023 – September 2023

Bureau of Land Management (BLM), Las Cruces District Office, Las Cruces, NM

Supervisor: Colin Dunn, M.Sc.

Curation of a paleontology resource teaching collection and management of paleontology resources

- Curated a collection of fossils for educational purposes
 - Identified various body and trace fossils of both marine and terrestrial origin
 - Utilized available literature to name fossils to the genus or species level
- Organized and created an inventory of collected fossils
 - Established a labelling convention for the categories of fossils
 - Created an organized spreadsheet that is easily accessible to Rangers and other public engagement staff
- Conducted proactive surveys
 - Searched for fossil material in areas of proposed digging or quarrying
 - Searched for fossil material in previously unexplored areas of expected fossil presence
- Monitored paleontology resources
 - Visited known localities and ensured paleontological resources had remained intact
 - Operated a Trimble device to store locality data
 - Operated 4x4 off-road vehicles

- Interacted with the public
 - Attended public meeting and engaged with the public about local paleontology resources located within Organ Mountains Desert Peaks Monument boundaries
 - Led an educational Paleontology public hike through Prehistoric Trackways National Monument

Student Researcher and Lab Assistant

March 2022 – June 2023

Tripati Lab, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisor: Aradhna Tripati, Ph.D. & Maxence Guillermic, Ph.D.

Clumped isotope geochemical analysis, carbonate biogeochemistry, climate change, paleoclimatology, and paleoceanography research using marine micro fossils

- Conducted mass spectroscopy
 - Prepared samples to run through specialized equipment
 - Operated high functioning machinery using specialized programs (Easotope)
 - Collected and organized data from the spectrometers
- Analyzed data
 - Processed data, determining and flagging outliers
 - Created figures using GraphPad Prism
 - Compared collected data to published data
- Handled and identified fossils
 - Used a microscope to identify the genus of benthic foraminifera
 - Cleaned foraminifera in preparation for analysis
- Reviewed literature and produced scientific writing
 - Read and compared the findings and methods of similar research studies to our own
 - Wrote reports, a senior thesis, and presentation on my research

Field Research Assistant

October 2022

GALE Lab, Department of Earth, Planetary, & Space Sciences, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisors: Taylor Dorn, Ph.D. & Mackenzie Day, Ph.D.

Assisted in the final phase of an Earth-Mars analogs field research project in Ibex Dunes, Death Valley National Park, CA

- Collected scientific instruments and gathered data
 - Hiked several miles through sand dunes to retrieve various instruments (up to 45 pounds) and carry them back to main camp
 - Recorded data from the field instruments
- Assisted in taking light detection and ranging (Lidar) data
- Located marked areas of scientific interest using a Global Positioning System (GPS)

PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Presentations

Stolo, G. & Taylor, S. (Apr. 2026). *Locals Only: Algal community structure is site and depth dependent in Caribbean Panama*. Poster presented at College of Science Student Research Symposium, CPP. Pomona, California.

Sengupta, S., **Stolo, G.**, Brown, C., Tandy, H., Biju, N., Guillermic, M., Kuppusamy, M., & Tripati, A. (Feb. 2024). *Clumped isotope-derived deep-ocean temperature and seawater $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ reconstructions for the deep Southern Ocean*. Poster presented at American Geophysical Union's Ocean Sciences meeting 2024. New Orleans, Louisiana.

Stolo, G., Guillermic, M., Tandy, H., Elliot, B., Matamoros, I., & Tripati, A. (May 2023). *Paleoclimate reconstruction of the late Miocene and Pliocene – Pleistocene transition in the Southern Ocean using benthic foraminiferal clumped isotope analysis*. Presentation given for UCLA Undergraduate Research Week 2023. Los Angeles, California.

Invited Talks

Stolo, G. (May 2024). *Monumental Careers in Federal Land Agencies*. UCLA. Los Angeles, California.

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Shawronna Sengupta (UCLA Undergraduate)

August 2022 – June 2023

TEACHING & OUTREACH EXPERIENCE

Park Ranger - Interpretation

May 2025 – current

NPS, John Day Fossil Beds National Monument, Kimberly, OR

Supervisor: Kathryn Sommer

Interpretation of local geology, ecology, paleontology, and history for the public and providing park information to visitors

- Staffing the visitor center
 - Informal interpretation and orientation for visitors
 - Completed visitor center opening and closing procedures
 - Operated the register, selling passes and merchandise
 - Encouraged participation in the Junior Ranger program and leading about 20 Junior Ranger swear-ins daily, fostering early appreciation for parks in discussing preservation, Leave No Trace, cultural history, science, and responsible recreation
- Developing programs
 - Used principles of the NPS thematic interpretation model through topic research, familiarity with and creative use of delivery techniques
- Visitor Safety
 - Actively promote the safety of park visitors and stewardship of park resources
 - Potentially serve as the initial contact for accident reporting and emergency assistance
 - Provided directions to visitors daily, enhancing safe navigation for drivers, motorcyclists, and cyclists throughout the park
 - Maintained readiness for life-saving interventions, including CPR and first aid, reinforcing park commitment to visitor well-being

Teaching Associate

August 2025 – current

CPP, Department of Biological Sciences, Pomona, CA

Supervisor: Rachel Sanchez, M.S.

Teaching introductory biology laboratories for undergraduate students.

- Instructor for two laboratory sections each semester
 - Prepared and delivered micro-lectures and led wet and dry laboratory activities
 - Grading and other classroom logistics such as creating a syllabus, course website, and responding to email inquiries

Cave Guide & Education Assistant

March 2024 – November 2024, May 2025 – June 2025

NPS, Oregon Caves National Monument and Preserve, Cave Junction, OR

Supervisor: Jamie Cleaver

Interpretation of local geology and ecology for the public, with a special focus on youth outdoor science education

- Lead interpretive guided cave tours
 - Guided small groups through the cave, interpreting the geology, ecology, and history
 - Lead up to three 90-minute tours each day
 - Delivered specialized tours including education (school group) tours and historic candlelight tours
- Lead school field trips
 - Provided curriculum-driven outdoor education tours to local schools
- Developed Dark Skies programming
 - Created two Dark Sky programs for general audiences
 - Created an Astronomy 101 presentation for fellow staff

- Community outreach
 - Educated university students about opportunities within federal land agencies
 - Represented the National Park Service at community events
- Resource management
 - Assisted in salamander surveys, butterfly surveys, bat surveys, owl surveys, and scat surveys
 - Assisted in a dye-trace hydrogeology experiment
- Digital communications management
 - Developed and posted social media content for official NPS accounts

Park Ranger - Interpretation

November 2024 – April 2025

NPS, Joshua Tree National Park, Twentynine Palms, CA

Supervisor: Dustin Schalue

Interpretation of local geology, ecology, and history for the public and providing park information to visitors

- Staffing the visitor center
 - Informal interpretation and orientation for visitors
 - Completed visitor center opening and closing procedures
 - Operated the register, selling passes and merchandise
 - Encouraged participation in the Junior Ranger program and leading about 20 Junior Ranger swear-ins daily, fostering early appreciation for parks in discussing preservation, Leave No Trace, cultural history, science, and responsible recreation
- Developing programs
 - Used principles of the NPS thematic interpretation model through topic research, familiarity with and creative use of delivery techniques
 - Created an evening program for an amphitheater – focus on nocturnal animals
 - Created a ranger chat hosted in the field – focus on birding
 - Created a specialty guided hike about plants and geology for a local indigenous youth corps
- Visitor Safety
 - Actively promote the safety of park visitors and stewardship of park resources
 - Potentially serve as the initial contact for accident reporting and emergency assistance
 - Provided directions to about 2,000 visitors daily, enhancing safe navigation for drivers, motorcyclists, and cyclists throughout the park
 - Maintained readiness for life-saving interventions, including CPR and first aid, reinforcing park commitment to visitor well-being

Field Teaching Assistant

May 2023

Department of Earth, Planetary, & Space Sciences, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisor: Kevin Coffey, Ph.D.

Provided logistical and teaching support to the leading instructor of UCLA's Historical and Regional Geology class while in the field

- Created and presented a night skies lecture
 - 45-minute long educational field lecture covering a wide variety of topics including stellar life cycles, star classification, constellation mythology, and how to recognize asterisms
- Led a bird walk
 - 30-minute river walk, identifying birds both by sight and sound
 - Gave instruction on how to recognize key morphological and song differences among birds
- Enforced field safety
 - Consistent head counts, reminders to stay hydrated, ensuring students kept on trail
- Handled emergency
 - Provided transport to the emergency room for a student, checked them in, took notes from the doctors
- Organized field gear and transportation
 - Assisted in packing several vehicles throughout the field trip, made sure all gear was accounted for
 - Drove an 8-passenger van rented from UCLA

UCLA Planetarium Volunteer*March 2023 – April 2023*

UCLA Planetarium, Department of Physics & Astronomy, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisors: Aidan Gibbs, Ph.D. & Luke Finnerty, Ph.D.

Developed and presented planetarium shows for the public

- 30-minute lecture on a special space science topic
 - Preparation and presentation of educational content about planet Earth geared toward the general public
- 30-minute simulated night sky presentation
 - Operated a planetarium projector
 - Pointed out specific stars, constellations, and other relevant objects, providing insightful information about how to locate them and their scientific relevance
 - Instructed on topics such as stellar life cycles, star classification, constellation mythology, galaxy dynamics, solar system formation, Earth's precession, and light pollution

Earth Sciences Outreach Educator*March 2023*

Department of Earth, Planetary, & Space Sciences, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisor: Emmanuel Masongsong

Preparation and delivery of educational, hands-on content about rocks and minerals for underserved students grades K-12

- Curated a collection of rocks and minerals for youth educational purposes
- Taught students about the different specimens displayed
 - Provided information about the rock cycle, distinguishing and identifying rocks, the environments where different rocks are found, and the structures within the rocks and how they relate to depositional environmental conditions
 - Taught students about the Mohs hardness scale, mineral structure, and what defines a mineral
- Took initiative to solve problems on the spot
 - Handled complications and facilitated disciplinary action
 - Adapted teaching style and methods to accommodate students affected by the interruption of the program

Peer Learning Facilitator*September 2021 – March 2022*

College of Letters and Science, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA

Supervisor: Joseph Fantone

Facilitation of Calculus and Astronomy courses for UCLA athletes

- Formation of targeted lessons based on student group dynamics
 - Curated lecture material to individual students to best match their learning styles, using a variety of presentation techniques
 - Fostered teamwork among students by designing group-based problem-solving activities
 - Prepared and presented curriculum-based educational programs virtually
- Professional development in education
 - Underwent training in education philosophy and methods

SPECIAL SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Public speaking, interpretation, and outreach
- Fieldwork, backcountry camping, and off-road vehicle use
- Mist-netting of birds and bats, use of acoustic recording units and camera traps
- Use of topographic maps and GPS
- Horizontal caving, scrambling, and hiking
- Snorkeling and swimming
- Leadership and teamwork
- Event organization
- Digital communications management

- Experience in R, Python, ArcGIS, C++, Matlab, Kaleidoscope, and SonoBat
- CPR, AED, and First Aid certified, valid through Sept. 2027